

Family First

Family is the defining motif in the fabric of urban Indian youth, more so for women, who look up to their parents and seek solace in their men

■ By Kaveree Bamzai

Coffee? Tea? It's the young woman propositioning the young man in the car as he drops her home. Juice? It's the tubelight-worthy young man replying to her in hope and triumph. It's an advertisement for a travel portal—and while it is clear she has sex, or at least romance on her mind, he can only think of liquid refreshment. It's a motif repeated in the Tata Indica Xeta ad, in which a gang of girls wants a surfer dude to rub suntan lotion on their backs, but he only scratches his head in befuddlement. Unlike men, women seem to have modernity figured out, wanting to work and requiring wooing too. But scratch the surface of the fun-seeking, spaghetti-strap-sporting collegiates and you get their sensible, sari-clad mothers, aiming for the stars but settling for stardust.

This is one of the several surprises in the INDIA TODAY-AC Nielsen-ORG-MARG survey of 16-30-year-olds across 14 cities—a snapshot of the to-die-for demographic of 280 million people in this age—which shows the primacy of family, a considerable gender gap and the importance of hard work. For both men and women, family comes first, but while the women lean on their men, the men seem to be leaning on their parents. Young women, smart consumers though they are in

Who do you consult most on your personal problems?

Parents	24
Spouse/boyfriend/ girlfriend	26
Friends/colleagues	22
Mother	8
No one	7
Siblings	5

*All figures in per cent
Rest: Don't know/Can't say
Figures don't add up to 100*

What are the top three things a woman looks for in a man before entering into a relationship?

Family background	26
Profession	18
Love	18

*All figures in per cent
Rest: Don't know/Can't say
Figures don't add
up to 100*

BANDEEP SINGH; MODELS:
SAURABH KHANNA, NASREEN
REHMAN, (Elite Model Management)

